Qingqing Yang

PhD student in Experimental Psychology | The Ohio State University
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Research Interests

Visual attention, memory, and decision-making.
Neural mechanisms of the goal-directed behaviors in human visual system.
Integrate behavioral measurements (psychophysics, eye-tracking) and neuroimaging (fMRI, TMS).

Education

The Ohio State University, OSU — 2024 – Present
Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology, 4/4 — Ohio, USA
Advisors: Hsin-Hung Li, Julie Golomb

New York University, NYU — 2021 – 2023
M.A. in Psychology, 3.97/4 — New York, USA
Advisor: Clayton Curtis

Zhejiang University, ZJU — 2017 – 2021
B.Sc. in Psychology, 3.92/4 — Zhejiang, China
Advisor: Hui Chen

Research Experience

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU — 08/2023 – 04/2024
Advisor: Clayton Curtis
Conducted behavioral (eye-tracking) experiments on prioritization effect in working memory (WM), while temporarily perturbed parietal cortex activity (TMS). (*In prep, talk at NMC 2022*).

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU — 09/2023 – 04/2024
Advisors: Catherine Hartley, Noam Goldway
Applied reinforcement learning models to quantify decision-making properties. Analyzed fMRI data to relate these properties to brain activities and clinical symptoms across development. (*In prep, abstract at CCN 2025).*

Publications

* denotes equal contributions.

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Efficient Allocation of Working Memory Resource for Utility Maximization in Humans and Recurrent Neural Networks. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems.* html

Zhu P*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2023). Working-Memory-Guided Attention Competes with Exogenous Attention but Not with Endogenous Attention. *Behavioral Sciences*, *13*(5), 426. doi: 10.3390/bs13050426

Manuscripts In Preparation

Yang Q, Curtis C (in prep). Effects of Interrupting Parietal Cortex Neural Activity on Working Memory Prioritization. *Talk presented at Neuromatch Conference (NMC), 2022.*

Goldway N, Harhen N, **Yang Q**, et al (in prep). Correspondence between reinforcement learning phenotypes and transdiagnostic clinical symptomatology across development.

Goldway N, ..., **Yang Q**, et al (in prep). Reliability of a reinforcement-learning task battery for computational phenotyping of decision-making in adolescent psychopathology.

Goldway N, ..., **Yang Q**, et al (in prep). Structural asymmetries in amygdala connectivity mediate valence-symmetry learning in humans.

Conference Workshops & Abstracts

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Reward Shapes Resource Allocation in Working Memory. *Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting Abstract.* html

Goldway N, Harhen N, **Yang Q**, et al (2025). Correspondence between reinforcement learning phenotypes and transdiagnostic clinical symptomatology across development. *Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN) Extended abstracts.* html

Han H W*, Dhar R*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2024). Investigating the role of modality and training objective on representational alignment between transformers and the brain. *NeurIPS Unireps Workshop.* html

Fellowships and Awards

Elsevier/Vision Research Travel Award**,** VSS	2026
Graduate Student Research Enhancement Awards (GSREA), OSU	2026
University Fellowship, OSU	2024

Professional Activities

Conference Reviewer: Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN).

Teaching Assistant

Sensation and Perception, OSU, undergrad	2026
Psychology of Creativity, OSU, undergrad	2025
Introduction to Psychology, OSU, undergrad	2025
Advanced Psychological Statistics, NYU, undergrad	2022